Survey Research Centre, Halvorsen University

To: Jeremy Morris, Programme Director, Health Access, Wexcombe Foundation

From: Heidi Roberts, Director. 2 November 2026. Re: grant WF-2026-117, placing the 2027 boost

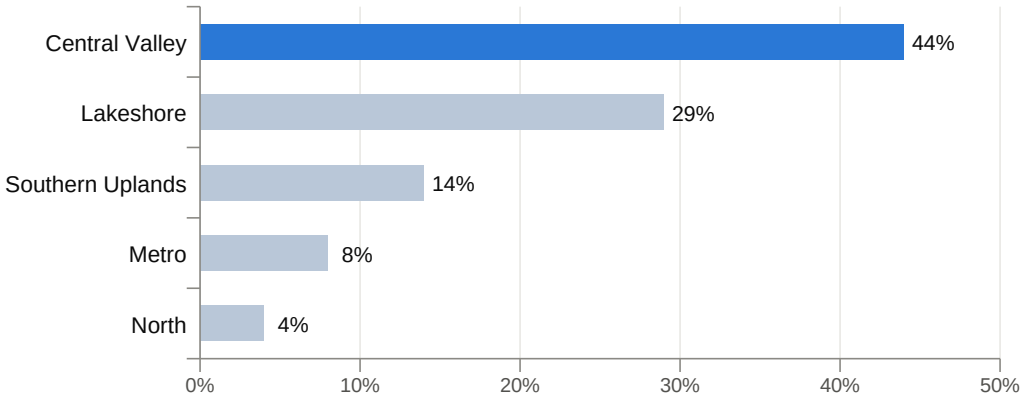
The 1,200 interviews should go to the Central Valley

Spread as 15 more completed interviews in each of its 80 sampled areas, the boost removes 44 per cent of the standard error of the Central Valley's 2027 estimate of households going without a prescription because of its cost. Lakeshore is next at 29 per cent, and only a boost of 27 more interviews in each of its areas (2,700 in all) would remove a larger share there than 1,200 remove in the Central Valley. The North, where the 2025 error is widest, gains 4 per cent: most of its error lies between communities, and interviews added inside the same communities do not reach it.

The Central Valley's error comes almost entirely from interviews within areas, and 34 per cent of its households live in the 20 new-subdivision areas, interviewed five to an area. Each of those interviews carries about 12 times the weight of a core interview, so an equal addition in every area quadruples the supplement's take and narrows the spread of the weights as well as adding sample: the weighting effect falls from 3.4 to 1.6. A projection that holds the 2025 design effect's weighting part fixed misses this and puts Lakeshore first.

The boost buys most precision in the Central Valley

Share of the region's 2027 standard error removed by 1,200 more completed interviews



Source: PHMS 2025 interviews, weights and areas; Survey Research Centre projection

Health region	Boost per area	Share of 2027 SE removed
Central Valley	**15**	**44%**
Lakeshore	12	29%
Southern Uplands	30	14%
Metro	20	8%
North	60	4%

The projections rest on the 2025 wave as the terms ask: each region's 2025 areas, takes and weights, the 2027 takes raised by the boost and the weights recomputed as the technical report sets out, and each region's intraclass correlation as Table 2 of the report publishes it. The workbook boost_region_2027.xlsx carries the working and each region's 2024 estimate on the current regions.